

Articulating Your Value

The Five Elements of a Compelling Story

We all have a story that summarizes where we are and where we are going. A powerful story highlights the value that you bring to an organization – whether it's within the same organization or in an entirely new industry. The following elements help to structure the information you provide, and help you determine what to include and what to exclude.

1. Identify what your target audience values

- Based on your research, what are the top three things your target audience values in candidates? How well does your background match these?

Resources:

- Utilize Career Services website and Fisher Career Resource Center for:
 - o Alumni > Conduct Research > A-Z Career Research Databases
 - o E/W > Careers > Research Career Components > Research Industries and Roles

Analyst Reports	Industry Surveys
GTS for Job Postings	Corporate Access Panels
Industry Profiles	

2. Understand your objective and message

- What is your objective for this conversation? Is it purely informational? Do you want to get some advice from this person? Are you interested in finding additional contacts? Do you want to get this person to offer you a job? No matter what your objective is, come prepared with some knowledge of the industry/company/person, and have questions ready. In any case, consider the most important things that you want to convey to your listener. Being clear on your objective helps you to tailor your message so that you are providing the appropriate amount of information.

Resources:

- Research companies by reviewing:
 - o Corporate website and YouTube channel(s)
 - o Company databases such as Capital IQ and Business Source
- Research alumni contacts through:
 - o Chicago Booth Alumni Directory: <https://alumniandfriends.uchicago.edu/booth/s/>
 - o LinkedIn for Chicago Booth: <https://www.linkedin.com/school/universityofchicagoboothschoolofbusiness/people/>

3. Demonstrate solid and concrete evidence to support your objective and message

- Based on your objective, what are relevant and succinct examples of the value that you bring? These can include direct experience, transferable skills, interpersonal attributes, education, volunteer leadership positions and entrepreneurial experiences.

Resources:

- Create an inventory of experiences and accomplishments
- Utilize SOAR framework: Situation, Obstacle/Opportunity, Action, Result

4. Build a bridge from your past experience to your career target

- Why are you making this transition now? What are the specific skills and experiences from #3 that serve as a bridge from your previous experience and demonstrate your commitment, understanding, and readiness to make this transition? Address gaps and mitigate risk for potential employers.

Resources:

- Review recorded mock interviews from INFocus to hear how others have told their stories; Available via the MediaSite

5. Maximize the impact of your delivery

- This is your opportunity to demonstrate your level of passion, energy and confidence about your next steps. Your delivery brings the story to life and engages your listener. Consider the following aspects of your style of delivery:
 - Speak firmly and at a comfortable pace
 - Maintain eye contact and use appropriate facial expression
 - Communicate with conviction and confidence
 - Use appropriate voice level without diminishment at the end of each sentence

Resources:

- Practice your story with others and ask for their input.
- Record yourself with your smartphone to critique your words and tone of voice, simulating a phone conversation

Resources:

Online:

- Alumni = Career Services > Changing Companies, Functions, and Industries > Telling Your Story
- E/W = Careers > Market & Prepare Yourself > Write Your Story

Books (Fisher Career Resource Center)

- *Self-promotion for Introverts* – Nancy Ancowitz
- *Me 2.0, Revised and Updated Edition: 4 Steps to Building Your Future* – Dan Schawbel
- *Maximum Influence: The 12 Universal Laws of Power Persuasion* – Kurt Mortensen

CareerCast (<https://www.chicagobooth.edu/careercast>)

- *Make Your Career Story Powerfully Compelling* – Rohit Bhargava
- *Delivering the Compelling Career Story* – Craig Wortman
- *Self-Promotion as a Career Strategy* – Nancy Ancowitz

General:

- Book a career coaching appointment via GTS or boothworks@ChicagoBooth.edu or 312-464-8677